

3 Procedures at Export

3.1 General

In the context of export there are two distinct locations where specified procedures take place. These locations, the office of export and the office of exit, may be the same or they may be different and in the case of indirect exports will be in different Member States. Goods for export are first presented to customs at the office of export and leave the Union at the office of exit.

3.2 Export Control System (ECS)

3.2.1 Introduction

The Export Control System (ECS) is an electronic system that is used throughout the European Union to control and monitor the export and exit of goods from the EU. The system enables the office of export in the Member State from which the goods were exported to communicate with the office of exit from which the goods being exported actually exit the Union. It should be noted however that it only applies to indirect exports - goods being exported directly from the Union, or moving under a Single Transport Contract, will not be affected. (The various types of export and the procedures applicable to each are described in paragraph 3.3 below.)

3.2.2 Master Reference Number (MRN)

The MRN is a unique number that is automatically allocated by AES when it receives and validates an export declaration.

It contains 18 digits and is composed of the following elements:

Field	Content	Field type	Examples
1	Last two digits of year of formal acceptance of import/export movement (YY)	Numeric 2	11
2	Identifier of the country from which the movement originates.	Alphabetic 2 (ISO alpha 2 country code)	IE
3	Unique identifier for the export movement per year and country	Alphanumeric 13	9876AB8890123
4	Check digit	Alphanumeric 1	5

3.2.3 Export Accompanying Document (EAD)

The function of the EAD is to show that an export declaration has been lodged and the shipment has been released for export where AES is not implemented. AES generates a Master Reference Number (MRN) (see above) which is required for the arrival at exit and exit notification messages. The customs authorities in some Member States may require notification of arrival of the goods at the customs office of exit to be communicated to them by other means, including presenting the hard copy EAD, until they implement UCC compliant systems. A sample of the EAD is at [Appendix 3](#).